



Presented by The High End

HEE-1 INTERSTELLAR COCKPIT

Life-Size Sit-In Cockpit — Faceted Canopy & Painted Control Desk

Build the canopy cockpit in the photo. Your pilot sits under the arch with the whole control desk in reach.

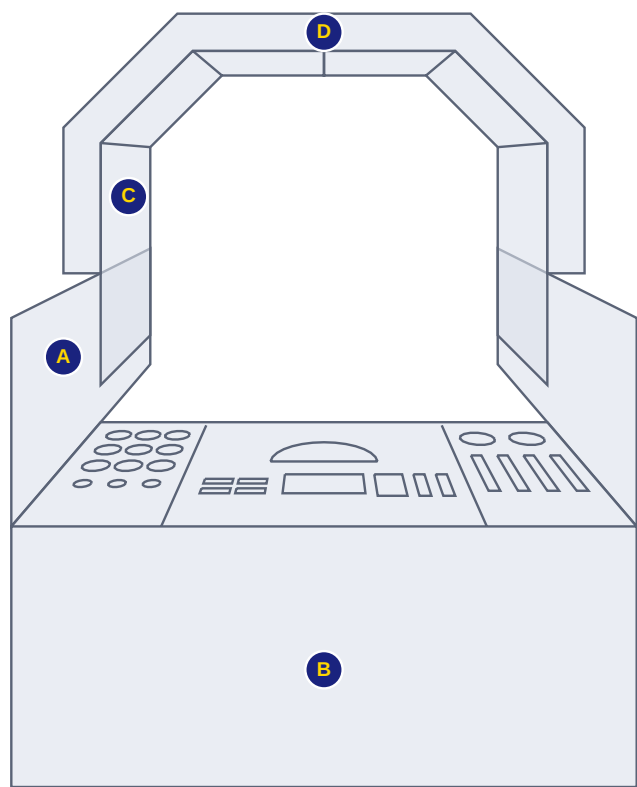
AGES 3–10	BOXES 2–3 Large Boxes	TIME 2–3 Hours	DIFF Intermediate **	PIECES 4 pcs
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CARDBOARD NEEDED:
2–3 Large Boxes (sides at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm))
FINISHED SIZE:
32" tall × 28" wide × 24" deep (81 × 71 × 61 cm) · desk top 10" (25 cm) off the floor · 30" (76 cm) headroom

MISSION GOAL:
Build the cockpit in the cover photo: two side walls, a flat desk at forearm height with every control painted on it, and a faceted canopy with a 2" front rim over the pilot. Plain cardboard everywhere except the painted controls.

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — HEE-1 INTERSTELLAR COCKPIT

The finished build, front view at the pilot's eye level, as the cover photo sees it, with every part in the place the steps put it and the letter from its own cut-template page. Parts are drawn at their real size relative to each other, so if a letter is on this picture there is a page for it in this file. Pieces that roll into a tube are shown rolled, not laid flat.

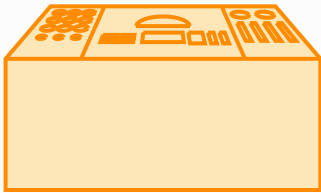


EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD			
A	SIDE WALL 24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm)	CUT ×2	
B	DESK 24" × 25" (61 × 64 cm)		CUT ×1
C	CANOPY HALF 28" × 12" (71 × 30 cm)	CUT ×2	
D	CANOPY RIM 28" × 14" (71 × 36 cm)		CUT ×1

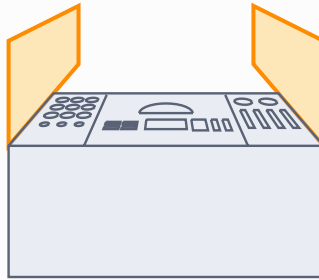
BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the build once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and yours should look like each picture in turn.

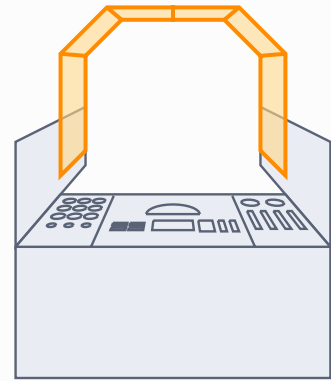
3 FOLD THE DESK



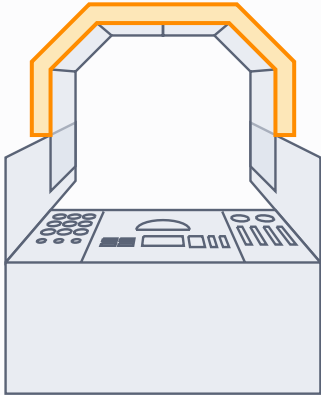
4 STAND THE SIDE WALLS



5 BUILD THE CANOPY



6 ADD THE CANOPY RIM

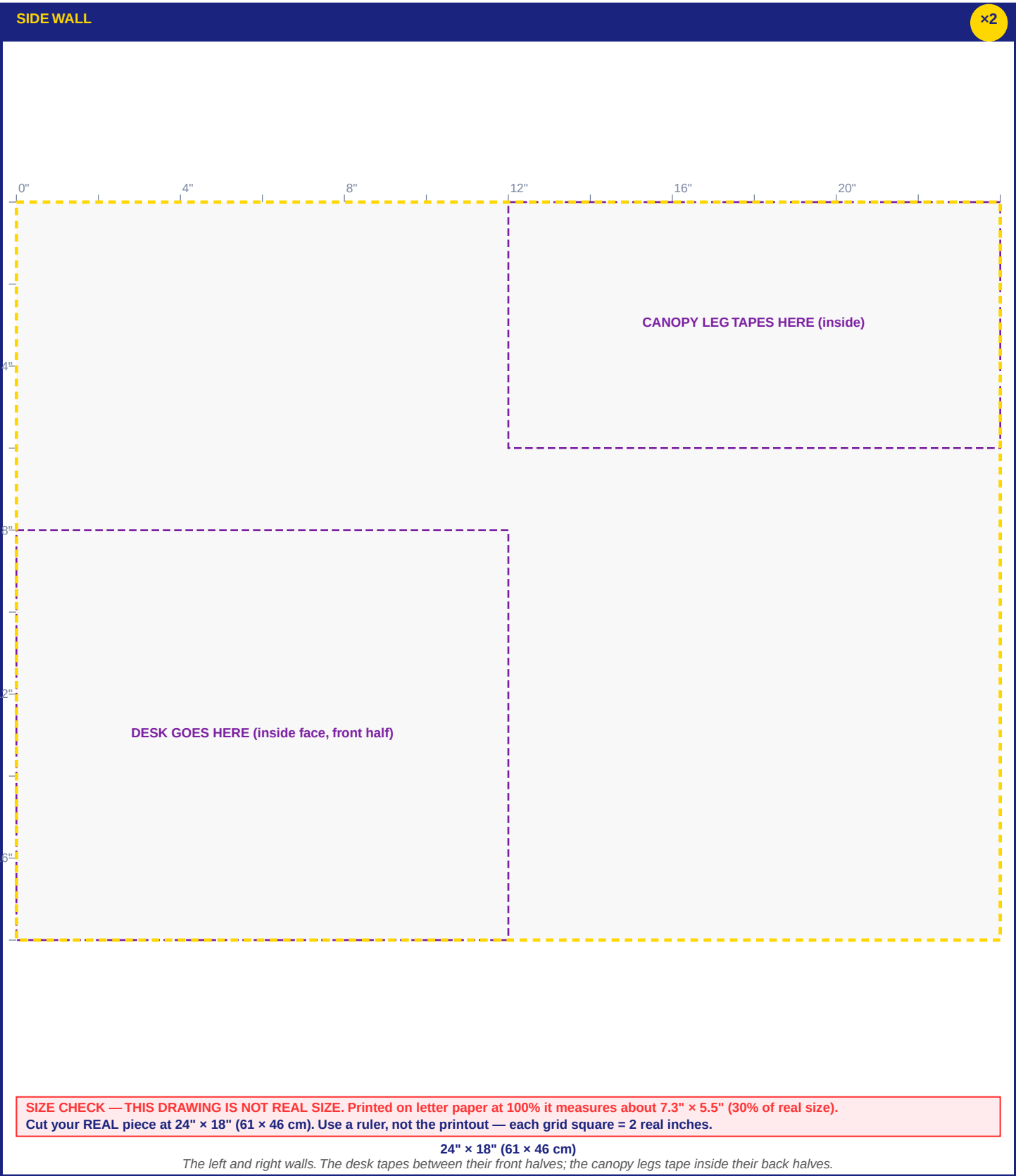




SIDE WALL

24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GLUE HERE — where another part goes

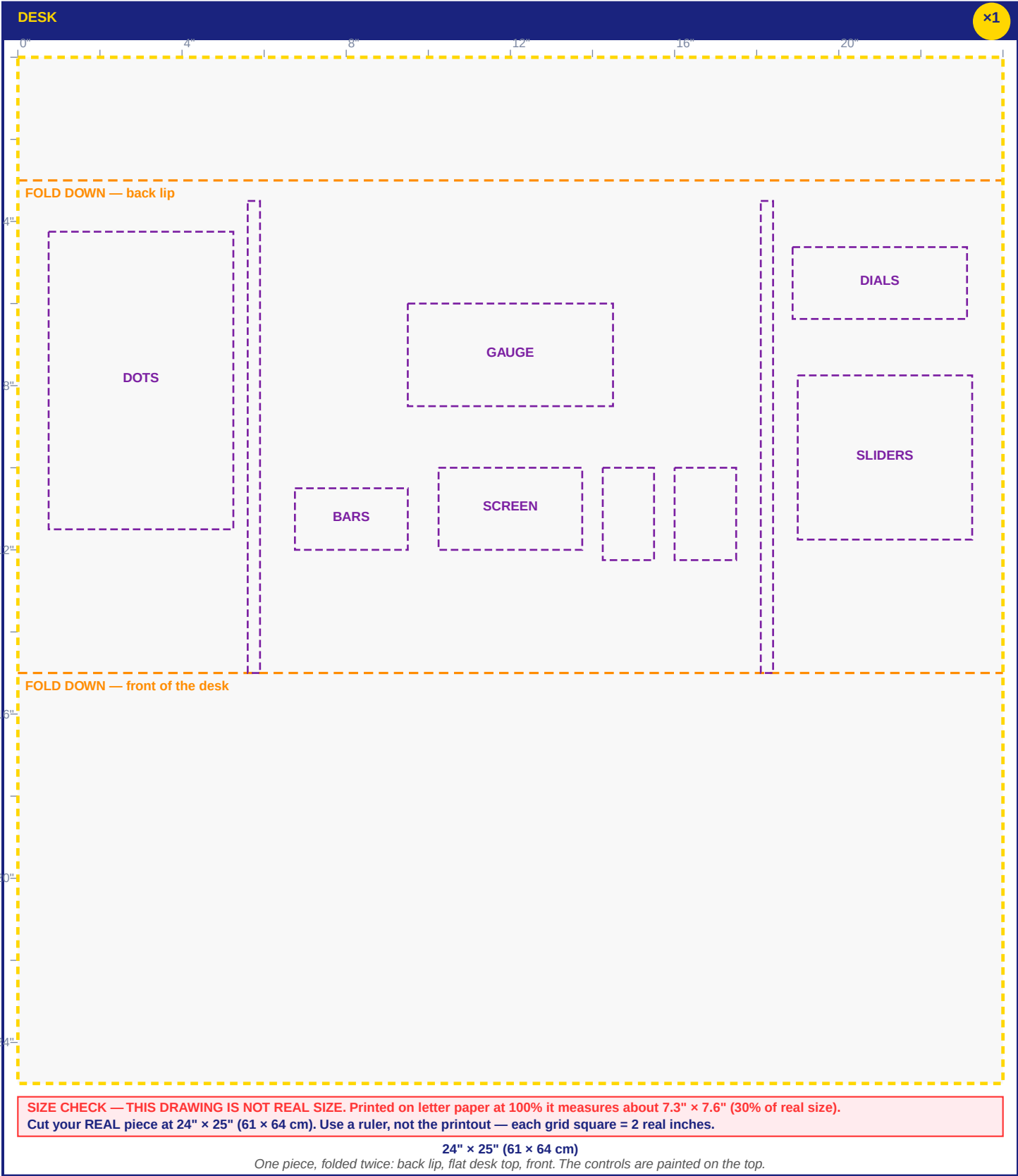
NOTE: The left and right walls. The desk tapes between their front halves; the canopy legs tape inside their back halves.



DESK

24" × 25" (61 × 64 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1



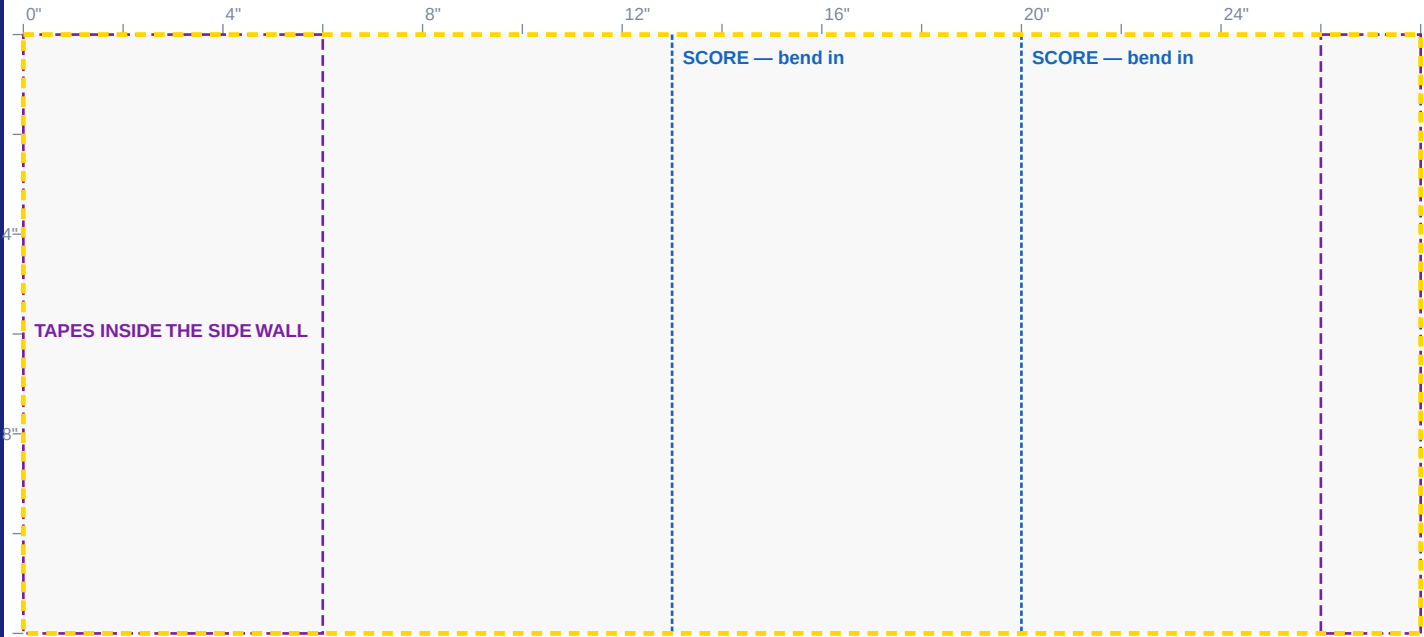
MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line	GLUE HERE — where another part goes
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NOTE: One piece, folded twice: back lip, flat desk top, front. The controls are painted on the top.



CANOPY HALF x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 3.1" (26% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 28" × 12" (71 × 30 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

28" × 12" (71 × 30 cm)
Bends at its 2 score lines into a straight leg, a slanted shoulder and half of the flat top. The narrow purple strip at the top end overlaps the other half.

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through	GLUE HERE — where another part goes
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NOTE: Bends at its 2 score lines into a straight leg, a slanted shoulder and half of the flat top. The narrow purple strip at the top end overlaps the other half.



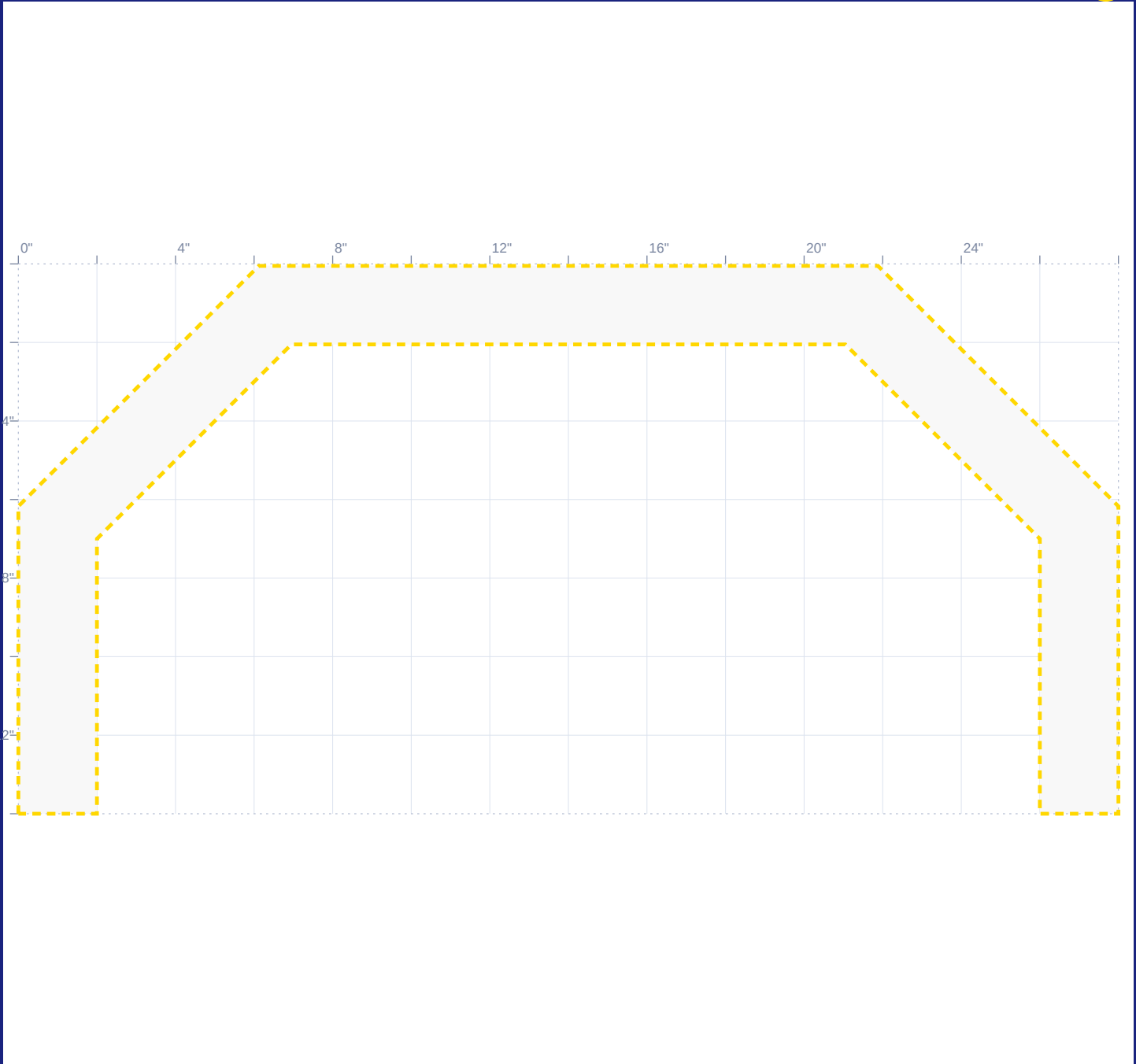
CANOPY RIM

28" × 14" (71 × 36 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

CANOPY RIM

x1



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 3.6" (26% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 28" × 14" (71 × 36 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
In the 28" × 14" box. OUTSIDE line: up each end 7.8", then a 45° line to the top edge 6.1" in from each end. INSIDE line: from 2" in at each bottom corner, up 7", then 45° to 2.1" below the top, 6.9" in from each end. Cut out the band between.
Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

28" × 14" (71 × 36 cm)
Canopy rim — a 2" faceted band, open at the bottom

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: The 2" band that frames the front of the canopy. Cut the inside out too.

WHAT YOU NEED — HEE-1 INTERSTELLAR COCKPIT

CARDBOARD PIECES — 4 TOTAL (2–3 Large Boxes (sides at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm)))

×2 Side Wall 24" × 18"

The left and right walls. The desk tapes between their front halves; the canopy legs tape inside their back halves.

×1 Desk 24" × 25"

One piece, folded twice: back lip, flat desk top, front. The controls are painted on the top.

×2 Canopy Half 28" × 12"

Bends at its 2 score lines into a straight leg, a slanted shoulder and half of the flat top. The narrow purple strip at the top end overlaps the other half.

×1 Canopy Rim 28" × 14"

The 2" band that frames the front of the canopy. Cut the inside out too.

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 2–3 large cardboard boxes

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Packing tape (2 rolls)

+ Long ruler, pencil + ballpoint pen (scoring)

+ Paint: red, orange, yellow, green, blue, white

+ Black marker for the outlines and lines

+ Glue gun — optional, adult only

+ A cushion for a small pilot (optional)

FUN FACT!

The International Space Station cockpit has over 1,000 switches. Add as many fake ones as you want.

CHALLENGE!

Mission debrief! Once seated, the pilot gives a 30-second report: Where are we going? What's the mission? What's the crew name?

1 STEP 1: MARK OUT THE PIECES

Flatten the boxes. On the plain side of the cardboard, mark out 2 of template A, 1 of template B, 2 of template C and 1 of template D, using the size and the HOW TO DRAW box on each template page. On B, pencil in the 2 fold lines and the purple control boxes now, while it is flat.

2 STEP 2: CUT AND SCORE

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

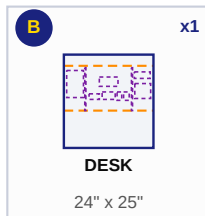
Cut out all 6 pieces on the gold outlines: 2 of A, B, 2 of C and D. D is one piece shaped like an upside-down U: cut out its inside too. Score every blue line on C and the 2 orange fold lines on B: press hard with a ballpoint pen along a ruler, never cut through.

SAFETY: Adult uses the box cutter. Kids can do the scoring.

3 STEP 3: FOLD THE DESK

Fold the Desk down along both orange lines: the 3" (8 cm) back lip folds down at the back and the front folds down at the front. Stand it on its front edge and lip. The top is now a flat shelf 12" (30 cm) deep and 10" (25 cm) off the floor, and the front is a solid face.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



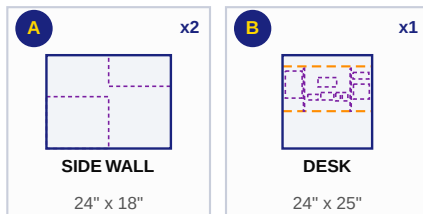
4 STEP 4: STAND THE SIDE WALLS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Stand the 2 Side Walls on their long edges, 24" (61 cm) apart and parallel. Slide the Desk between their front halves so its front lines up with the front edges of the walls (the purple DESK box on template A). Tape both ends of the desk to both walls, inside and outside, along every edge that touches.

SAFETY: Two people: one holds the walls, one tapes.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



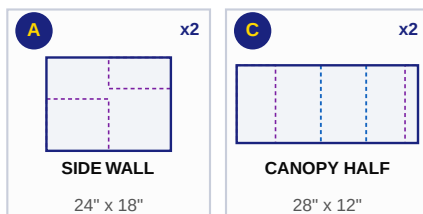
5 STEP 5: BUILD THE CANOPY

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Bend each Canopy Half inward along its 2 scored lines: a straight leg, a slanted shoulder, then half of the flat top. Tape the bottom 6" (15 cm) of each leg flat against the inside of a Side Wall's back half (purple box on template A), flush with the back edge, so the leg stands straight up 7" (18 cm) above the wall. Lean the two tops together until they overlap about 2" (5 cm) in the middle, and tape the overlap inside and out. The canopy is now a faceted tunnel 12" (30 cm) deep over the back half.

SAFETY: Two people: one holds both halves up, one tapes.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



6

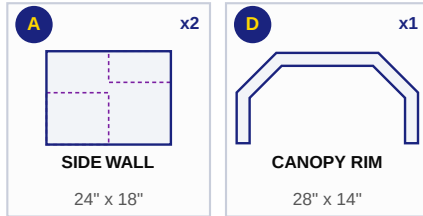
STEP 6: ADD THE CANOPY RIM

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Hold the Canopy Rim against the FRONT edge of the canopy so the inside edge of the band lines up with the inside of the canopy all the way round and its two feet sit on top of the side walls. Tape it to the canopy from behind the band, all the way round, and tape the feet to the walls. The 2" (5 cm) band now frames the canopy like the cover photo.

SAFETY: If you use a glue gun, adult only.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



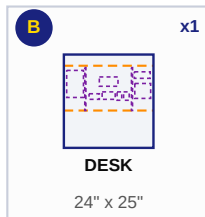
7

STEP 7: PAINT THE LEFT CONTROLS

Everything is painted FLAT on the desk top, where the purple boxes on template B show. Left and right are as you face the cockpit from the front, like the photo. Paint 3 rows of 3 dots, each 1.25" (3 cm) across: red, blue, green / orange, red, blue / yellow, red, green. In front of them, a row of 3 small dots 0.75" (2 cm) across: red, blue, green. Draw a black line from the back of the desk to the front, 5.75" (15 cm) in from the left edge.

SAFETY: Water-based paint. Let it dry before anyone leans on the desk.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

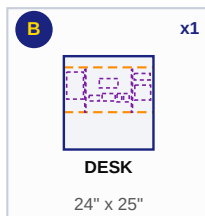


8

STEP 8: PAINT THE CENTRE CONTROLS

In the middle, paint a gauge: a half circle 5" (13 cm) wide, round side toward the back, its flat edge 5.5" (14 cm) from the back of the desk top. Paint its rim as a band of 5 blocks, red and blue in turn, and draw a black needle from a black centre dot. Toward the front: 4 small bars 1.25" (3 cm) long (green, blue / red, yellow); a blue screen 3.5" (9 cm) wide with 4 short white lines on it; a level meter 1.25" (3 cm) wide in 3 cells (blue, green, green); then a red bar and a blue bar, each 0.5" (1 cm) wide.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



9

STEP 9: PAINT THE RIGHT CONTROLS

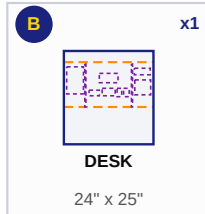
Draw a second black line from back to front, 18.25" (46 cm) in from the left edge. To its right, at the back: 2 round dials 1.75" (4 cm) across, one green with a black star needle and one blue with a red wedge. In front of them: 4 slider tracks 0.5" (1 cm) wide and 4" (10 cm) long (green, red, red, red), each with a black knob 1" (3 cm) wide part way along. Outline every control in black marker, like the photo.

10

STEP 10: QUALITY CHECK

Everything except the controls stays plain brown cardboard — walls, canopy and rim are not painted. The pilot climbs in from the open back, sits on the floor and rests their forearms on the desk; a small child can sit on a cushion so their head is close under the canopy like the photo. Push down on the desk and the canopy: nothing should sag or come loose. Compare to the cover photo: faceted canopy with its rim, walls on both sides, painted desk. That's the standard.

SAFETY: An adult checks every tape joint before a child climbs in.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP**QUALITY CHECK!**

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations